NONPROFITSDAILY

Your Year-End Appeal in 30 Days

A checklist for small nonprofit teams: one week at a time

WEEK 1

Plan

- [ ] Set one goal: a dollar amount and a donor count
- [ ] Pick one story, one need, one ask
- [ ] Pull your list and split it three ways: current donors, lapsed donors, warm prospects
- [ ] Choose your channels (letter, email, social, a personal call list), only what your team can finish

WEEK 2

Write

- [ ] Lead with a person, not your organization
- [ ] Name one real outcome and say what a gift does
- [ ] Make one clear ask with one clear link
- [ ] Thank donors before you ask again
- [ ] Write the letter first, then adapt it to email, social posts and a call script
- [ ] Get one person outside your team to read it

WEEK 3

Launch

- [ ] Mail the letter so it lands before Giving Tuesday (December 1, 2026); send your first email the same week
- [ ] Make personal calls and write handwritten notes to your top donors
- [ ] Post your story on social with your donation link
- [ ] Test your donation page on a phone
- [ ] Confirm receipts send automatically

WEEK 4

Follow up

- [ ] Send a reminder to everyone who hasn't responded, and a different message to those who have
- [ ] Thank every donor within 48 hours and tell them what their gift will do
- [ ] Send a deadline email on December 30 and 31
- [ ] Track results: gifts, donors, and which channel worked